



the Juan Fernández Islands and Easter Island (Chile), the Fernando de Noronha Archipelago (Brazil), and the Falkland Islands, a British dependency claimed by Argentina as the Islas Malvinas. In terms of

both size and population, the biggest country is Brazil. Most people in South America are descended from indigenous Indians, Portuguese or Spanish colonists, African slaves, or a mixture of these groups.

South American statistics



LANGUAGES

Reflecting the region's colonial past, European languages are the most widely spoken. Quechua and Guarani are indigenous tongues.

Portuguese	153 million
Spanish	117 million
Quechua	5 million
Guarani	2.5 million



RELIGIONS

South America is unusual in its religious uniformity. Roman Catholicism, another colonial legacy, dominates significantly.

Roman Catholic	268 million
Protestant	4.3 million
Jewish	889,000
Hindu	365,000



URBAN POPULATION

South America's cities are constantly growing in population. Most of the big urban centers are near the coast.

São Paulo	18 million
Buenos Aires	12 million
Rio de Janeiro	11 million
Lima	8 million



POPULATION BY COUNTRY

Over half the continent's population live in Brazil. French Guiana has the smallest number of people.

Brazil	176 million
Colombia	41 million
Suriname	436,500
French Guiana	182,000

POPULATION

The population of South America is about 350 million, with 76 percent of these people living in urban areas. Currently, the continent's population is growing at a rate of about 7 percent every five years.



SOUTH AMERICAN FACTS

PLACES

Number of countries12 (plus dependencies)
 Highest pointCerro Aconcagua,
 Argentina, 22,833 ft (6,959 m)
 Lowest pointValdés Peninsula,
 Argentina, -151 ft (-40 m)

LITERACY RATE

90% of the population

HEALTH

People per doctor1,100
 Proportion of people
 with access to clean
 water86%